WhatsApp Chat Forensic Analysis Report

Own-Device Chat Export Analysis — Training Case File

Report Type:	WhatsApp Chat Export Analysis (Own Data)
Case Number:	WA-001
Examiner:	Muhammad Shoaib
Date of Analysis:	25 August 2026
Source Data:	WhatsApp "Export Chat (Without Media)" .txt file
Contact Reference:	Asif Laptop (saved contact name)
Consent Basis:	Data exported from examiner's own WhatsApp account

1. Executive Summary

This report documents the forensic review of a WhatsApp chat export obtained directly from the examiner's own device using WhatsApp's built-in "Export Chat" feature (Without Media option). The export was analyzed for message content, shared location data, and conversational patterns. Two shared Google Maps links were identified within the chat and were resolved to their underlying physical locations to demonstrate location-tracing methodology used in digital forensic investigations.

2. Source Data Details

Field	Value
Export Method	WhatsApp > Chat > Export Chat > Without Media
File Format	Plain text (.txt)
Total Messages Recovered	13 text messages + 2 shared location links
Limitation Noted	Timestamps were not preserved in this export format

3. Methodology

1. Exported the target chat from WhatsApp using the built-in Export Chat (Without Media) function.
2. Transferred the resulting .txt file to the examiner's workstation for offline review.
3. Manually reviewed the plain-text content for message context, shared media links, and metadata.
4. Identified two shortened Google Maps URLs (maps.app.goo.gl) embedded in the conversation.
5. Resolved each shortened URL by following its HTTP redirect to obtain the full Google Maps destination URL, which reveals the place name, address, Plus Code, and Google Place ID.

4. Findings

4.1 Message Content Summary

The recovered conversation consists of informal planning messages between the examiner and the contact saved as "Asif Laptop." The content centers on arranging a meeting time ("Suba 10 11 bje?" / "Subha milty hy"), standard greetings ("Hii", "Asalam o alaikum"), and two shared location links. No content indicating threats, harassment, or illicit activity was present in the reviewed data.

4.2 Shared Location Trace Results

#	Shortened Link	Resolved Location
1	maps.app.goo.gl/SNc84giB...	Mir Chakar Khan Brohi Hotel, Karachi-Hyderabad Motorway, Sector 51-A, Gulzar-e-Hijri Scheme 33,
2	maps.app.goo.gl/iJ5ACc3Z...	Kababjees Restaurant & Bakers, Super Highway, Scheme 33, Sector 4-B, Gulzar-e-Hijri, Karachi

4.3 Geographic Correlation

Both resolved locations fall within the same general area of Karachi (Gulzar-e-Hijri / Super Highway corridor), approximately in proximity to one another. This is consistent with the conversational context, which discusses arranging an in-person meeting. In a real investigative context involving multiple shared locations over time, this method can be extended to reconstruct a subject's movement pattern or established meeting points.

5. Conclusion

The exported chat data was successfully parsed and reviewed. Both embedded location links were successfully de-shortened and resolved to specific, named physical locations in Karachi. This demonstrates a standard technique in digital forensics for extracting geographic intelligence from messaging app data: shortened links are not analyzed at face value but are resolved through their redirect chain to recover the full location metadata.

6. Recommended Next Steps (for a real investigative case)

1. Recover the full .msgstore.db database (via device backup) rather than a text-only export, to preserve exact timestamps for each message and location share.
2. Cross-reference shared timestamps against other digital evidence (call logs, GPS data) to build a verified movement timeline.
3. Use a forensic tool such as Autopsy or a dedicated WhatsApp parser to automate extraction and timeline generation across larger datasets.
